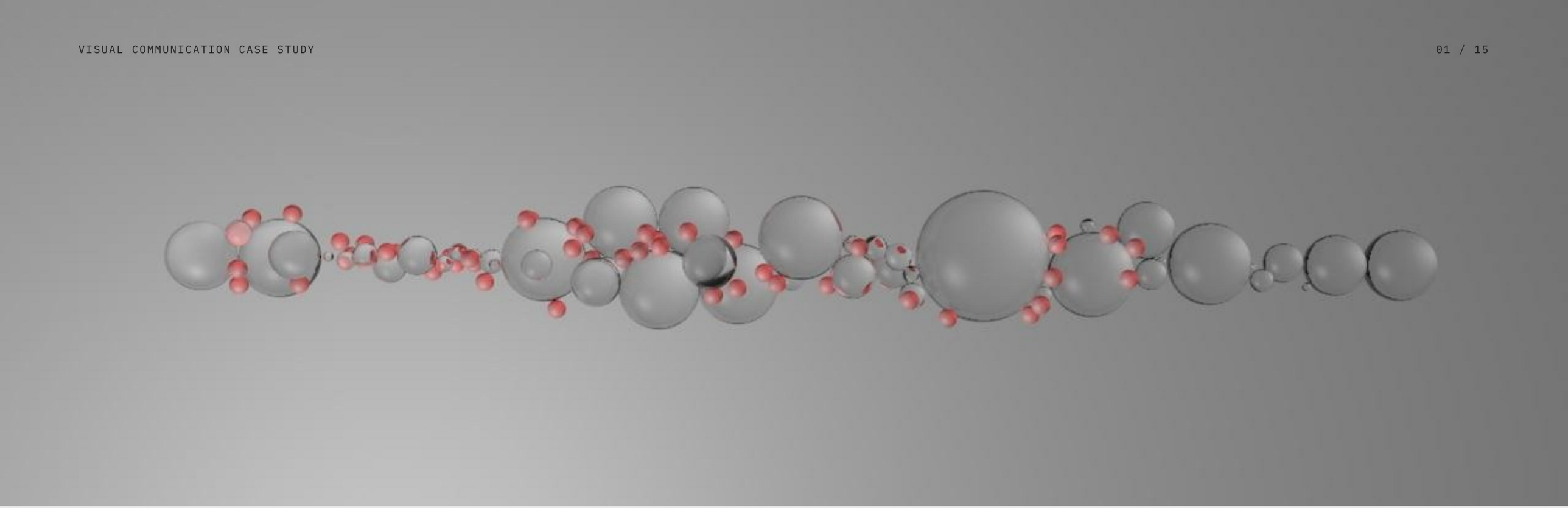


Sunny days between cubes

Translating everyday movements into a visual language

What if everyday human activity could be translated into a choreography of shapes, lines and moving images?

YEAR
February 2023

CONTEXT
Sapienza University of Rome

FIELDS
Choreography · performance · transmedia · exhibition design

DESIGN
Setayesh Ganji

02 — BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Observe, translate, return

The project moves in three steps. First a real place is observed: a resting area where students write, type and talk. Then those ordinary actions are scored and translated into shapes and animation. Finally the images return to the same tables as an exhibition.

The original animations are videos; here they appear as stills.

Red is the score
Every red mark is a movement translated into a shape.

Top-down footage
Frames come from one fixed camera above the tables.

Phases build up
Each phase adds one action; the last combines them.

CONTENTS BOARD

OBSERVE

The idea	Choreography, scoring and the everyday	03
The site	A shaded resting area at Sapienza	04
Reading the space	Plan, light, shadow and movement	05
Point of view	Photographs and the camera angle	06

TRANSLATE

The vocabulary	Four actions, four shapes	07
Phase 1 · Writing	Zigzag lines	08
Phase 2 · Typing	Squares	09
Phase 3 · Conversation	Circles and sound waves	10
Phase 4 · All together	The combined score	11
References	Forsythe and Synchronous Objects	12

RETURN

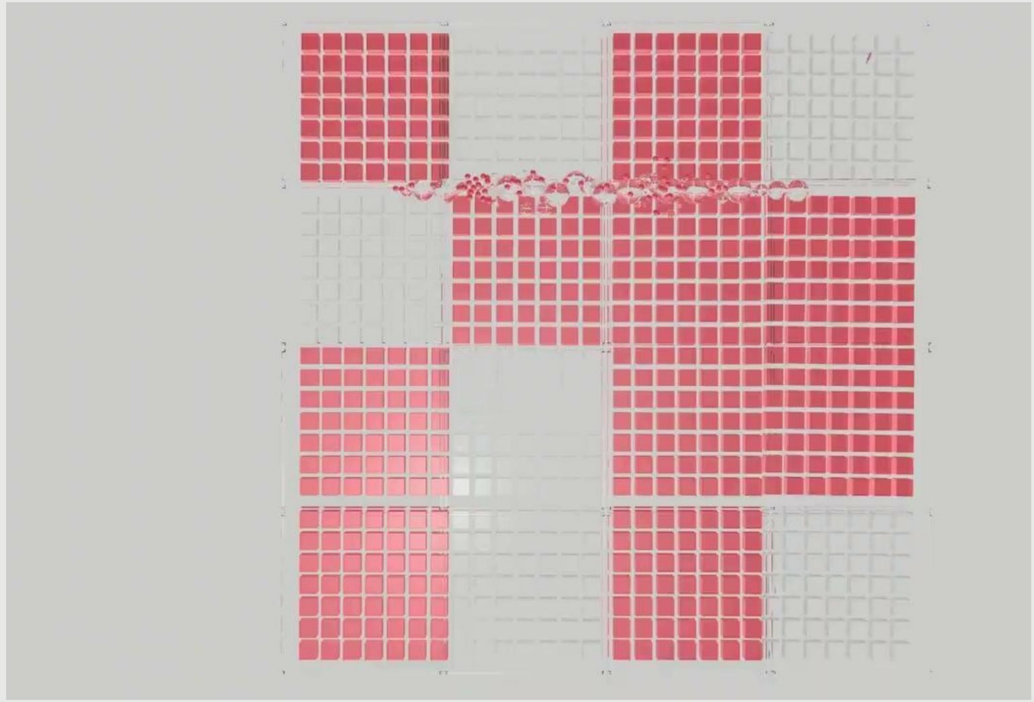
Exhibition	The images go back to the tables	13
At night	Light and projection on site	14
Credits	What the project shows	15

03 — THE IDEA

Choreography without dancers

Choreography has always changed its methods and purposes. With the tools of scoring — writing actions down precisely — any movement can be recorded, abstracted and turned into another form of art.

This project applies that idea to the most ordinary movements there are: students writing, typing and talking at their tables. Their gestures become simple shapes, the shapes become videos, and the videos become an exhibition in the heart of Sapienza, one of Europe's oldest universities.



Final phase: every action, scored and animated together

01

Observe

people in a real place

02

Score

each action as a mark

03

Animate

the marks as moving images

04

Return

the images to the place

04 — THE SITE

A resting place made of stripes

Observing the architecture, movement and conversation at different hours of the day, the project settled on the resting area in the north-western part of Sapienza's main campus.

Eight large tables, two benches on each side, and a ceiling of countless rods that throws striped shadows across everything — changing hour by hour. Students come here to study, chat, rest, eat, read and write.

8
tables

16
benches

∞
shadow stripes



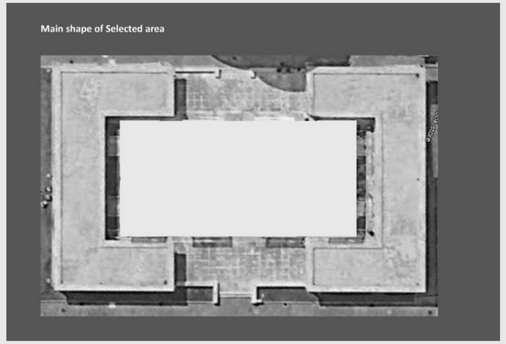
Site photographs and aerial view, Sapienza main campus

05 — READING THE SPACE

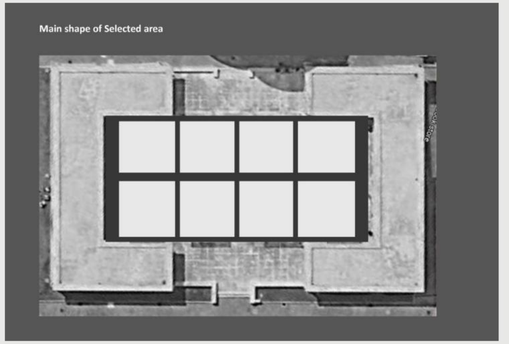
From plan to grid

The site was redrawn as data: its outline, the grid of tables, the rhythm of the roof's stripes, the paths people take and the light that falls at midday.

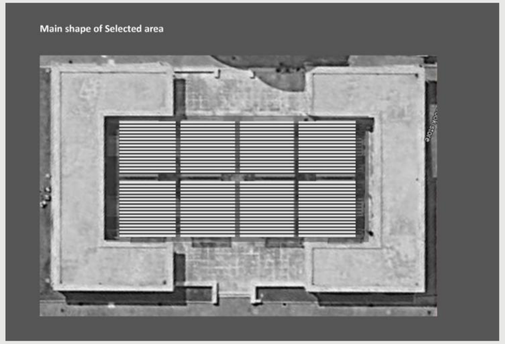
Step by step the analysis narrows from the whole courtyard to one table — the stage where every recorded action takes place.



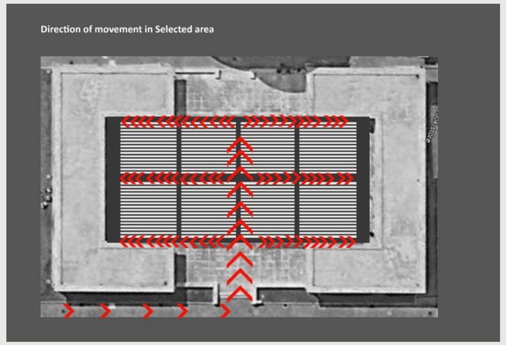
01 Main shape



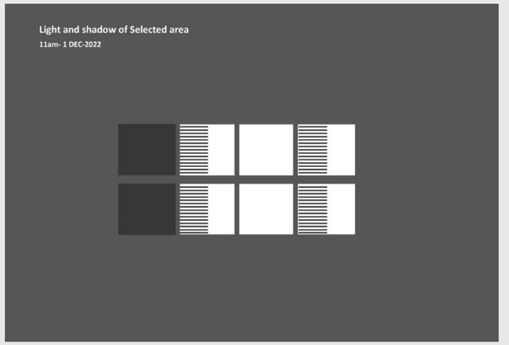
02 Eight tables



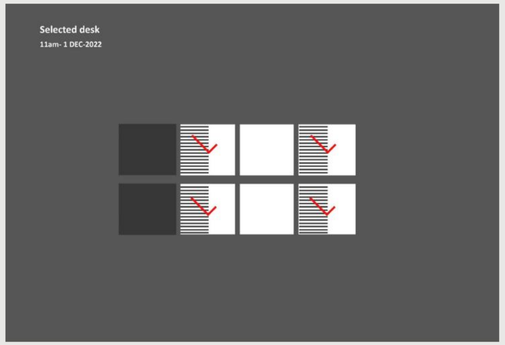
03 The striped roof



04 Directions of movement

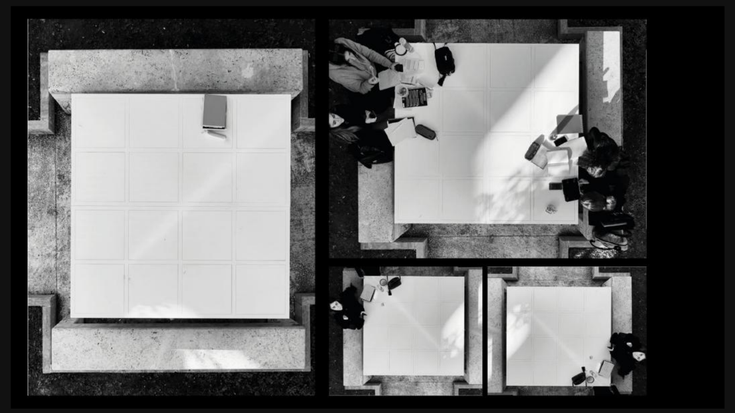


05 Light and shadow · 12 pm



06 The selected desk







06 — POINT OF VIEW

Looking straight down

Photographing the site in black and white made its real subject visible: hard lines of shadow, the grid of tables, bodies as dark shapes against light surfaces.

For recording, the camera was placed directly above the tables. From this angle a person becomes a moving mark on a flat plane — already halfway to a drawing.



07 — THE VOCABULARY

Four actions, four shapes

Each everyday action was watched closely until its rhythm could be named, then given one simple graphic form. Together they make a small alphabet for movement.

PHASE 1 01

Writing

Hands rise and fall, again and again

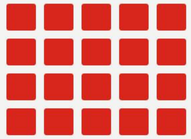


BECOMES **Zigzag line**

PHASE 2 02

Typing

Fingers on a keyboard



BECOMES **Squares**

PHASE 3 03

Talking

Two people in conversation



BECOMES **Circles + sound waves**

PHASE 4 04

Everything

A group writing, typing and talking at once



BECOMES **The combined score**

08 — PHASE 1

Writing

→ zigzag lines

Midday, a boy in a red shirt sits alone at the far left corner of the table. His only action is writing: his hands go up and down, again and again. Scored not as parallel lines but as a zigzag, the gesture becomes lines that are free to move through space.

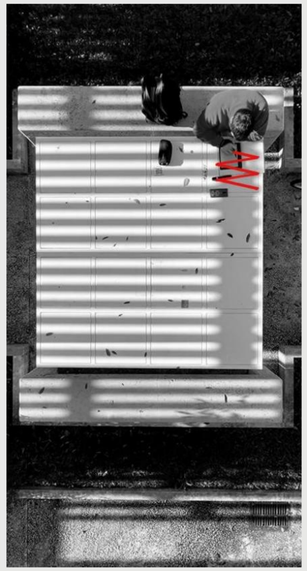
> *A spiral brings the question of avoidance… you establish a line in space and then you avoid the line — move under it, or over it.*
>
> After William Forsythe, on lines in movement



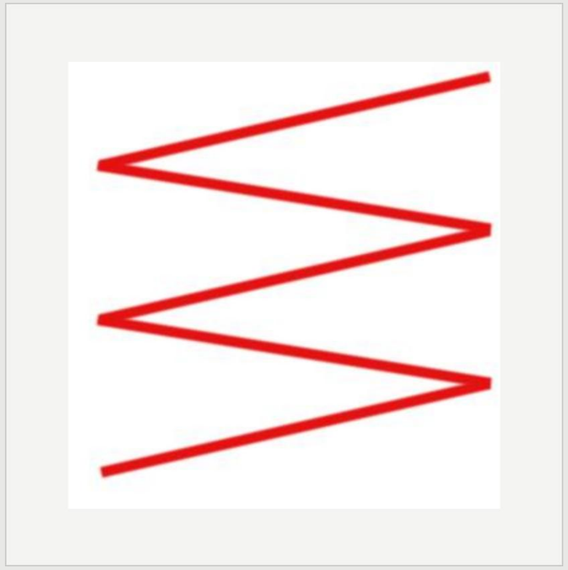
Recorded



Watched



Scored



The score

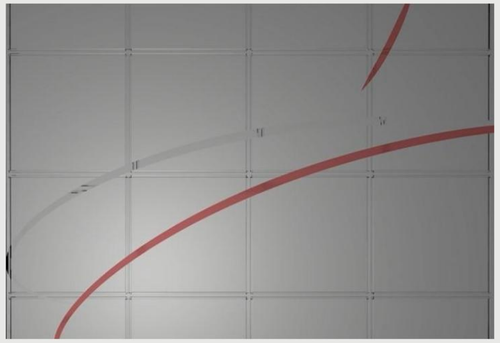
THE OUTCOME · VIDEO STILLS



A line appears



It turns



It spirals through space

09 — PHASE 2

Typing

→ squares

Around 1:30 pm, a boy in a grey shirt sits alone at the far right corner, typing the whole time. The keyboard itself gave the form: each keystroke becomes a small square, and the squares multiply until they cover the table.

> *A door knob is a circle — so we can take that door knob and, in one second, knock it off.*
>
> After William Forsythe, on room writing



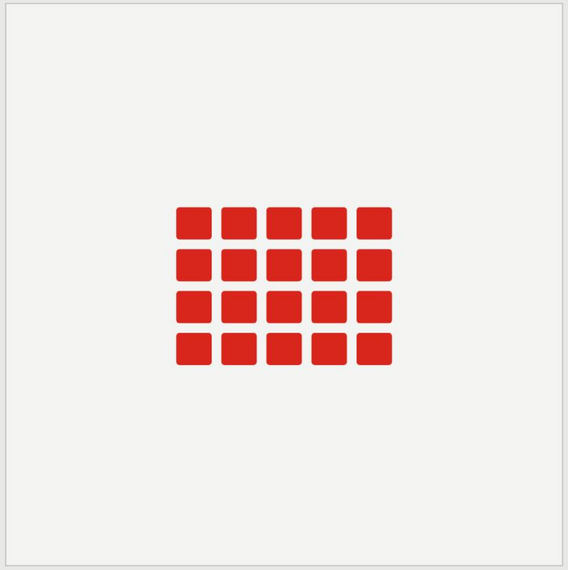
Recorded



Watched

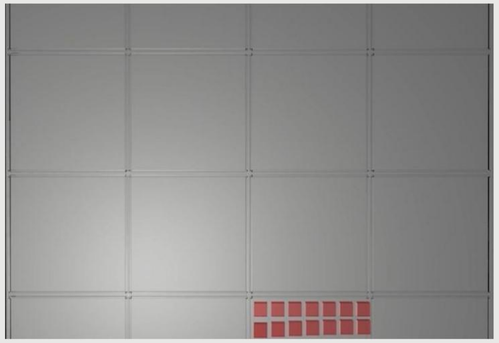


Scored

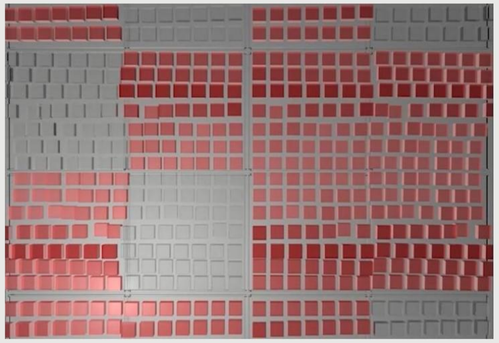


The score

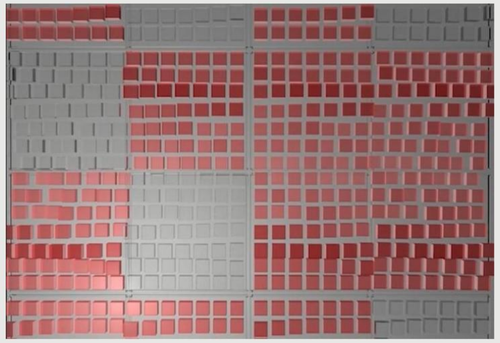
THE OUTCOME · VIDEO STILLS



One block of keys



The grid fills



Squares cover the table

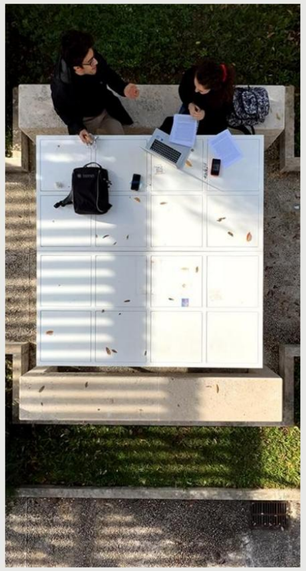
10 — PHASE 3

Talking

→ circles and sound waves

A boy and a girl talk without stopping. Their exchange is scored twice: as circles that pass between them, and as the waveform their voices produce — the visible shape of a daily conversation.

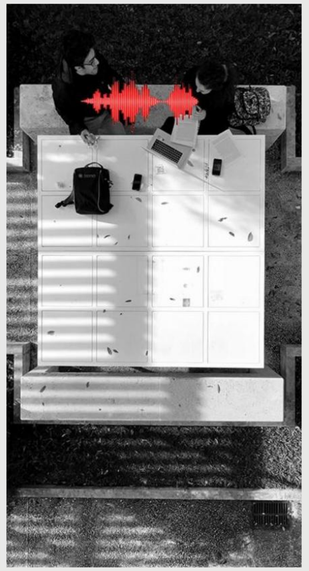
> *Dances… that can also mix speech, video, sound, light and movement… proffer purely abstract worlds of gorgeous, endlessly inventive shape and form.*
>
> William Forsythe



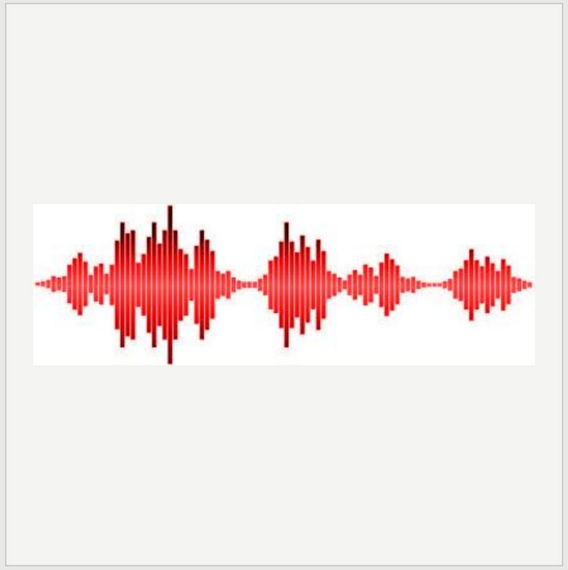
Recorded



Watched

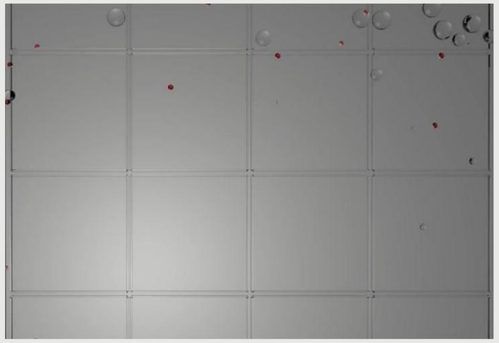


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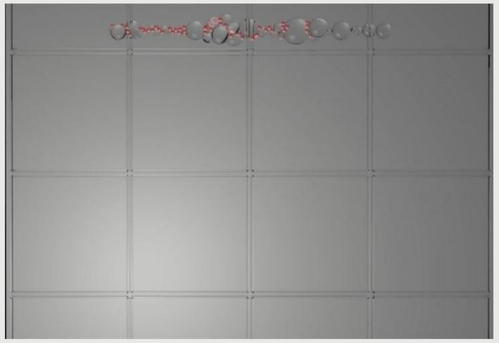


The score

THE OUTCOME · VIDEO STILLS



Voices appear



They gather



Spheres in conversation

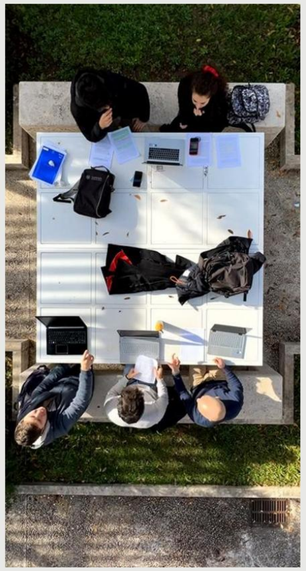
11 — PHASE 4

Together

→ the combined score

Finally a group does everything at once — speaking, writing and typing. The last video layers all three translations on the same table, so the hum of the place becomes a single, busy choreography.





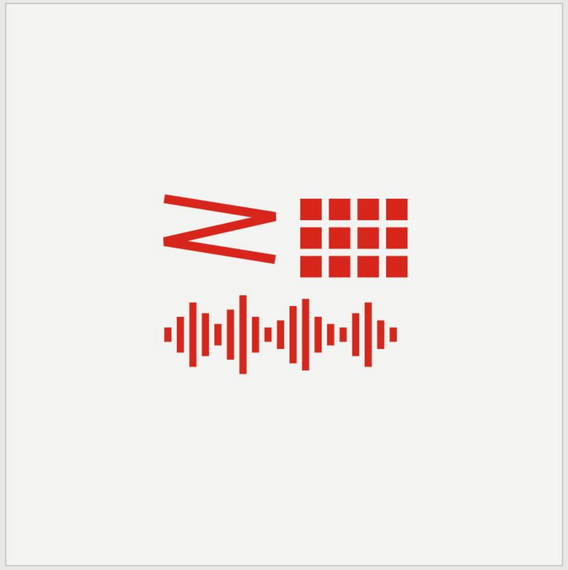
Recorded



Watched

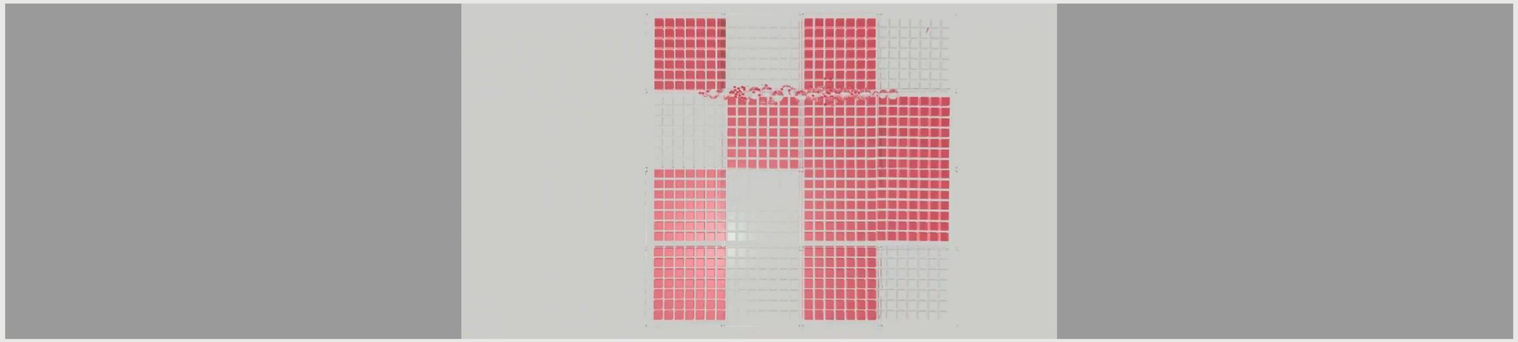


Scored



The score

THE OUTCOME · VIDEO STILLS



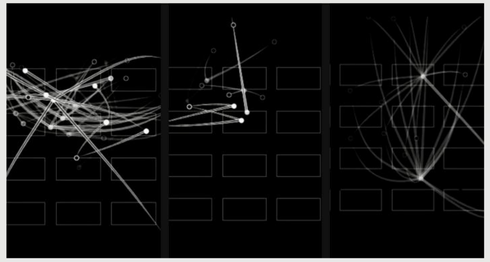
Lines, squares and waves on one table

12 — REFERENCES

Learning from Forsythe

Two sources shaped how the scores were read and animated: William Forsythe's writing on lines, rooms and the mixing of media in dance — quoted in each phase — and Synchronous Objects, his project with Ohio State University that turns the dance One Flat Thing, reproduced into data visualisations.

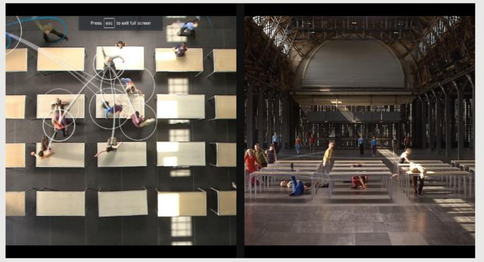
Images on this board belong to Synchronous Objects (The Forsythe Company and The Ohio State University) and are shown as research references.



Cue Visualizers

Show cues over time and let the viewer compress and overlap them.

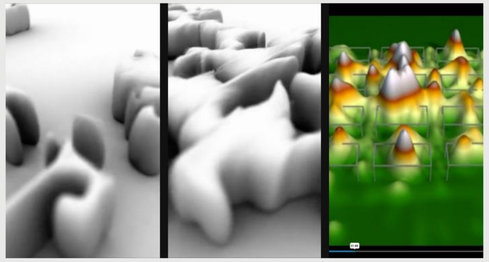
USED IN Phase 1 — lines



Cue Annotations

Watch the dance's cueing system unfold as a shifting network of relationships.

USED IN Phase 3 — circles



Motion Volumes

The outer edges of dancers' motion in One Flat Thing, reproduced, become volumes that emerge and dissolve.

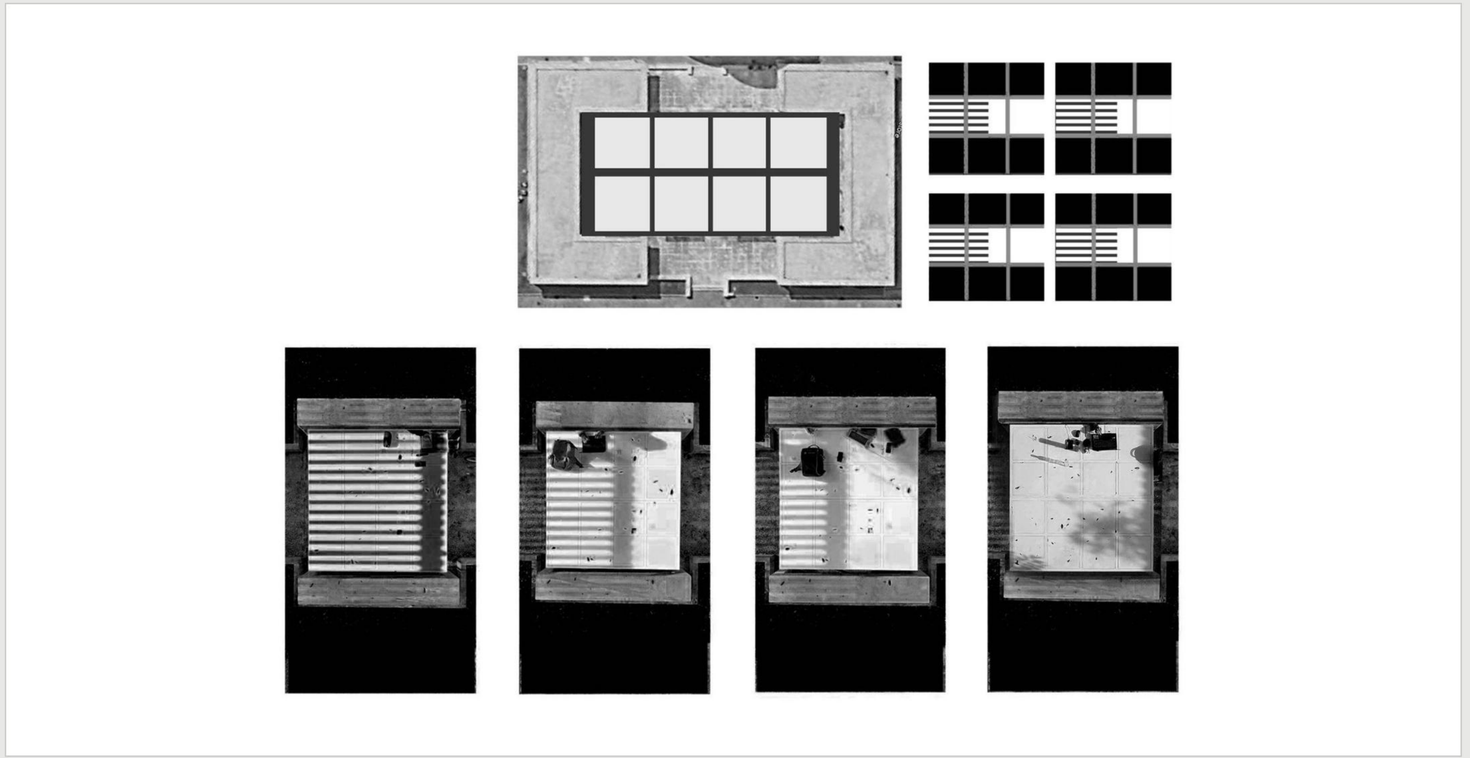
USED IN Phase 4 — 3D forms

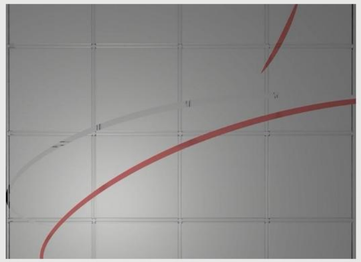
13 — EXHIBITION DESIGN

Back to the tables

The transmedia step closes the loop. The exhibition sits exactly at the centre of the site: each video is shown on the very table where its movements were recorded and scored.

Visitors see the hustle and bustle of the day replayed as shapes, in the place it came from.

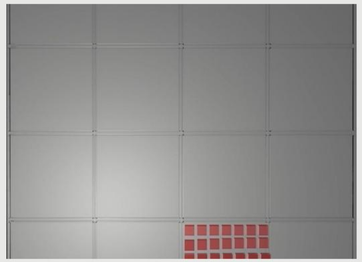




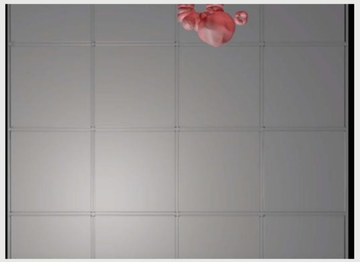
Writing



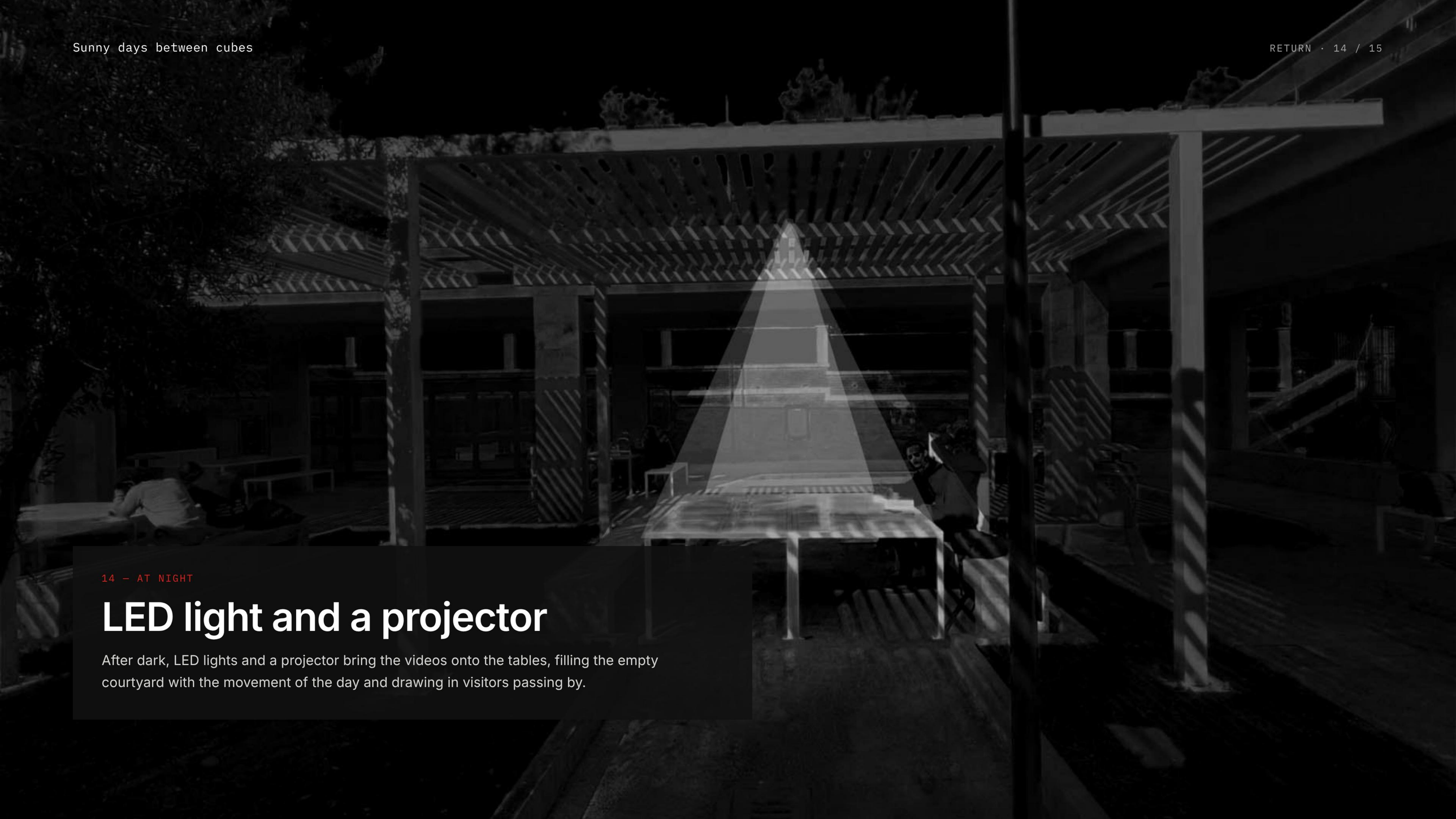
Talking



Typing



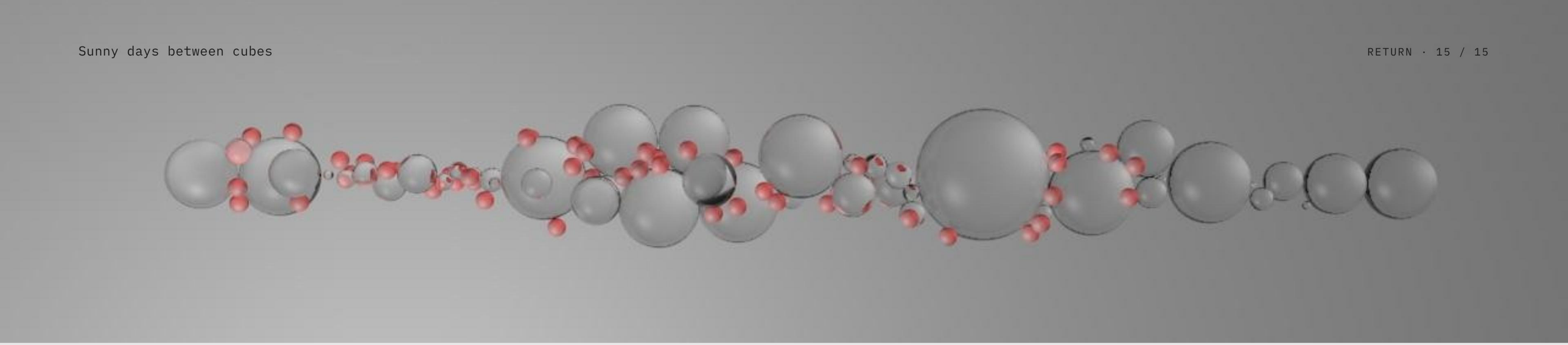
Circles



14 — AT NIGHT

LED light and a projector

After dark, LED lights and a projector bring the videos onto the tables, filling the empty courtyard with the movement of the day and drawing in visitors passing by.



15 — CREDITS

The hidden rhythm of an ordinary day

Writing, typing, talking: movements nobody notices, made visible as a choreography of lines, squares and waves — and returned to the place they came from.

DESIGN	Setayesh Ganji
FIELDS	Choreography, performance, transmedia and exhibition design
CONTEXT	In collaboration with Sapienza University of Rome · February 2023

Observation

Reading a real space — architecture, light, people — and choosing what to record.

Scoring

Turning gestures into a consistent graphic vocabulary.

Motion

Animating the scores as videos that keep the rhythm of the original action.

Exhibition

Designing how the work returns to its site, by day and by night.